

Reading Comprehension

Passage 1

Q1. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

1. Paleontologists have argued for a long time that the demise of the dinosaurs was caused by climatic alterations associated with slow changes in the positions of continents and seas resulting from plate tectonics. Off and on throughout the Cretaceous (the last period of the Mesozoic era, during which dinosaurs flourished), large shallow seas covered extensive areas of the continents. Data from diverse sources, including geochemical evidence preserved in seafloor sediments, indicate that the Late Cretaceous climate was milder than today's. The days were not too hot, nor the nights too cold. The summers were not too warm, nor the winters too frigid. The shallow seas on the continents probably buffered the temperature of the nearby air, keeping it relatively constant.
2. At the end of the Cretaceous, the geological record shows that these seaways retreated from the continents back into the major ocean basins. No one knows why. Over a period of about 100,000 years, while the seas pulled back, climates around the world became dramatically more extreme: warmer days, cooler nights; hotter summers, and colder winters. Perhaps dinosaurs could not tolerate these extreme temperature changes and became extinct.
3. If true, though, why did cold-blooded animals such as snakes, lizards, turtles, and crocodiles survive the freezing winters and torrid summers? These animals are at the mercy of the climate to maintain a livable body temperature. It's hard to understand why they would not be affected, whereas dinosaurs were left too crippled to cope, especially if, as some scientists believe, dinosaurs were warm-blooded. Critics also point out that the shallow seaways had retreated from and advanced on the continents numerous times during the Mesozoic, so why did the dinosaurs survive the climatic changes associated with the earlier fluctuations but not with this one? Although initially appealing, the hypothesis of a simple climatic change related to sea levels is insufficient to explain all the data.
4. Dissatisfaction with conventional explanations for dinosaur extinctions led to a surprising observation that, in turn, has suggested a new hypothesis. Many plants and animals disappear abruptly from the fossil record as one moves from layers of rock documenting the end of the Cretaceous up into rocks representing the beginning of the Cenozoic (the era after the Mesozoic). Between the last layer of Cretaceous rock and the first layer of Cenozoic rock, there is often a thin layer of clay. Scientists felt that they could get an idea of how long the extinctions took by determining how long it took to deposit this one centimeter of clay and they thought they could determine the time it took to deposit the clay by determining the amount of the element iridium (Ir) it contained.
5. Ir has not been common at Earth's surface since the very beginning of the planet's history. Because it usually exists in a metallic state, it was preferentially incorporated in Earth's core as the planet cooled and consolidated. Ir is found in high concentrations in

some meteorites, in which the solar system's original chemical composition is preserved. Even today, microscopic meteorites continually bombard Earth, falling on both land and sea. By measuring how many of these meteorites fall to Earth over a given period of time, scientists can estimate how long it might have taken to deposit the observed amount of Ir in the boundary clay. These calculations suggest that a period of about one million years would have been required. However, other reliable evidence suggests that the deposition of the boundary clay could not have taken one million years. So the unusually high concentration of Ir seems to require a special explanation.

6. In view of these facts, scientists hypothesized that a single large asteroid, about 10 to 15 kilometers across, collided with Earth, and the resulting fallout created the boundary clay. Their calculations show that the impact kicked up a dust cloud that cut off sunlight for several months, inhibiting photosynthesis in plants; decreased surface temperatures on continents to below freezing; caused extreme episodes of acid rain; and significantly raised long-term global temperatures through the greenhouse effect. This **disruption** of the food chain and climate would have eradicated the dinosaurs and other organisms in less than fifty years.

Answer the questions given below.

1. According to paragraph 1, which of the following is true of the Late Cretaceous climate?

- A. Summers were very warm and winters were very cold.
- B. Shallow seas on the continents caused frequent temperature changes.
- C. The climate was very similar to today's climate.
- D. The climate did not change dramatically from season to season.

2. Why does the author mention the survival of "snakes, lizards, turtles, and crocodiles" in paragraph 3?

- A. To argue that dinosaurs may have become extinct because they were not cold-blooded animals
- B. To question the adequacy of the hypothesis that climatic change related to sea levels caused the extinction of the dinosaurs
- C. To present examples of animals that could maintain a livable body temperature more easily than dinosaurs

D. To support a hypothesis that these animals were not as sensitive to climate changes in the Cretaceous period as they are today

3. According to paragraph 3, which of the following is true of changes in climate before the Cretaceous period and the effect of these changes on dinosaurs?

A. Climate changes associated with the movement of seaways before the Cretaceous period did not cause dinosaurs to become extinct.

B. Changes in climate before the Cretaceous period caused severe fluctuation in sea level, resulting in the extinction of the dinosaurs.

C. Frequent changes in climate before the Cretaceous period made dinosaurs better able to maintain a livable body temperature.

D. Before the Cretaceous period there were few changes in climate, and dinosaurs flourished.

4. The word “fluctuations” is used in paragraph no.3 in the passage that is closest in meaning to

A. extremes

B. retreats

C. periods

D. variations

5. The word “disruption” is used in paragraph no. 6 in the passage that is closest in meaning to

A. exhaustion

B. disturbance

C. modification

D. disappearance

6. Why higher concentration of Ir requires a special explanation according to paragraph no.5? Explain.

7. In paragraph no. 6, what scientists have hypothesized about the colliding effect of an asteroid? What impact did it bring on the climate of the earth?

8. Summarize the passage in not more than 7 sentences.

Passage 2

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

Morality, good manners, and intelligence are the key to success in any business. Moku was endowed with great intelligence. The future held **a great promise** for him. At school, he was brilliant and passed the his-final examination with flying colours. However, Moku was plagued by some undesirable traits in his character: he was prone to bouts of anger and was ill-mannered. After school, he succeeded in setting up a publishing house which **flourished** because of his hard work and the huge sums of money he sank into the **enterprise**. As his business experienced a boom his products sold like hot cakes. His name became a household word.

It was at this crucial time that Moku's ill manners began to come to the fore. Maybe his success got into his head and he would not take the advice of his managers nor draw on their expertise. Even when his workers had good suggestions for improvement, he would not listen but treated them with **disdain**.

Gradually he began to sink under the weight of his own bad behaviour. He lost his customers and his profits **dwindled**. Consequently, his publishing business almost collapsed. He learned the bitter lesson that because of his wrong attitude he was filling his mind with negative emotions, such as suspicion and hatred. He also lost the respect of his workers because he often quarreled and fought with them.

Fortunately, Moku realized his plight and was determined to turn his life around. He joined the *Praise and Worship Sanctuary* and began to turn over a new leaf. His golden opportunity came one day when he met two foreign businessmen who showed interest in his publishing industry.

Impressed by his knowledge and expertise, the foreigners formed a partnership with him and his publishing business began to grow again in leaps and bounds. People could not believe their eyes when they saw the change that had come in Moku's character.

Indeed, good behaviour is a **potent** advertisement.

Answer the questions given below.

- (a) What showed that Moku had a bright future?
- (b) Mention two factors that accounted for Moku's initial success in business.
- (c) Give two reasons why Moku's business almost collapsed.
- (d) How did Moku's bad behaviour affect him personally?
- (e) Why did the foreign businessmen decide to form a partnership with Moku?

(f)in leaps and bounds.

(i) What does this idiomatic expression mean according to the context of the given sentence?

(g) For each of the following words, write/ suggest another word or phrase which means the same as the word and can replace it in the passage;

(i) endowed,

(ii) flourished,

(iii) enterprise,

(iv) disdain,

(v) dwindled,

(vi) potent.

h. Draft a précis of the above text in about 100 words and suggest a suitable title.

Passage 3

Q1. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions on it.

1. Some consumers choose to purchase bottled drinking water, rather than relying on city tap water supplies. Bottled water has typically been extracted from underground sources. If water exists underground, but has no natural exit points, bottling companies may construct a water table well by drilling down to extract water from an unconfined aquifer. This is done when the Earth's natural water level – known as a water table – is much lower than the Earth's surface. In some cases, as with a valley or gully on a mountain, the level of the water table may be higher than the Earth's surface, and a natural spring can emerge. Bottling companies are permitted to extract this water from a hole drilled into the underground spring, but the composition of the water must be identical to that of the naturally surfacing variety nearby.

2. Artesian water is drawn from a confined aquifer, a deep underground cavity of porous rock that holds water and bears pressure from a confining layer above it. This water can be accessed if companies drill a vertical channel down into the confined aquifer. Due to the pressurized nature of this aquifer, water will often rise up from within it and form a flowing artesian well, which appears as an explosive fountain at the earth's surface. However, this only occurs when the surface is lower than the natural water table. If the surface is not lower than the natural water table, it is still possible to draw artesian water by using an extraction pump.

3. Some bottled water is advertised as ‘purified’, which means it has been subjected to a variety of different cleansing processes. A common filtering procedure, known as reverse osmosis, involves the water being pressed through microscopic membranes that prevent larger contaminants from passing through. The microscopic size of these holes is such that they can even obstruct germs, but they are most effective against undesirable materials such as salt, nitrates, and limescale. One disadvantage of reverse osmosis is that a lot of unusable water is generated as a by-product of the procedure; this must be thrown away.

4. For treating pathogens, an impressive newer option is ultraviolet (UV) light. Powerful UV light has natural antibacterial qualities, so this process simply requires water to be subjected to a sufficient strength of UV light as it passes through a treatment chamber. The light neutralizes many harmful germs by removing their DNA, thereby impeding their ability to replicate. A particularly impressive quality of UV light is its ability to **neutralize** highly resistant viral agents such as hepatitis.

5. The overall effects of UV light treatment are variable, however, which leaves many municipal water treatment processes relying on chlorination. Its powerful and comprehensive antimicrobial effect notwithstanding, chlorination is also extremely inexpensive and remains the only antimicrobial treatment capable of ensuring water remains contaminant-free all the way through the pipes and to the taps of domestic homes. Many members of the public remain suspicious of water that has been treated with such a harsh chemical. Its ease of use and affordability has meant that chlorine often plays an important role in making tainted water supplies safe for consumption immediately after natural disasters have occurred.

6. Some water also undergoes distillation. This involves water being boiled until it converts to steam, which then passes through a cooling tube and becomes water again. Toxic compounds and impurities such as heavy metal residue are left behind in this process, so the steamed water is typically cleaner than the pre-distilled version. Unfortunately, distillation equipment also removes up to fourteen types of beneficial minerals that naturally occur in water. Consequently, those who rely on distilled water may need to take mineral supplements.

7. In developed countries, all forms of drinking water are typically subject to stringent quality control processes, so there is little evidence to suggest importing bottled water at significant expense will be safer or healthier than regular tap water from a municipal drinking supply. Both tap water and bottled water are tested for pathogens and contaminants and, aside from isolated cases related to issues such as faulty plumbing or old pipes, tap water is harmless. Nevertheless, many purchasers of bottled water still justify their choice on the quite reasonable basis that tap water has a distinctly unpleasant aftertaste related to the chlorination process it has undergone.

Answer the questions given below.

1. What is a ‘water table’? How do companies construct water tables?

2. How do companies purify water? Point out two method for water purification provided in the passage.
3. In paragraph no.5, what does the author suggest about the ‘chlorination process’? why is it important?
4. What do you understand by the term distillation? How does this process take place according to paragraph no.6?
5. How can we make drinking water safe to drink in Pakistan? Suggest two methods for effective water purification on a daily basis.
6. Which TWO of the following claims about water are made by the writer?
 - A. Bottled water is overpriced.
 - B. Tap water may not have a nice flavour.
 - C. Most people should drink bottled water.
 - D. Tap water is usually safe to drink.
 - E. Public water supplies need better maintenance.
7. In paragraph no.1, the word ‘**emerge**’ is used. Provide another word that has a similar meaning as emerge.
8. What do you mean by the word ‘**neutralize**’ according to the context of the sentence used in paragraph no. 4?
9. **Draft a précis of the above text in about 100-120 words and suggest a suitable title.**